FIFA

2026 EDITION

FIFA QUALITY PROGRAMME FOR ELECTRONIC PERFORMANCE & TRACKING SYSTEMS

APPLICATION GUIDE

VERSION SEPTEMBER 2026



Introduction

The FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS devices was initially launched in 2017 with the aim of ensuring that wearable tracking systems used in football do not pose a danger to the players. Test criteria were developed following medical and mechanical testing and a test protocol reflects possible injury scenarios which are to be avoided. The International Football Association Board (IFAB) accounts for the use of Electronic Performance and Tracking Systems in the Laws of the Game update in 2017/2018. Under Law 4, The Players' Equipment, the IFAB introduced a minimum standard, 'FIFA Basic' (previously known as 'IMS' – International Match Standard – until July 2021) for any wearable tracking system that is to be used in official matches under the auspices of FIFA.

Electronic performance and tracking systems (EPTS)

Where wearable technology (WT) as part of electronic performance and tracking systems (EPTS) is used in matches played in an official competition organised under the auspices of FIFA, confederations or national football associations, the competition organiser must ensure that the technology attached to the players' equipment is not dangerous and meets the requirements for wearable EPTS under the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS.

Where EPTS are provided by the match or competition organiser, it is the responsibility of that match or competition organiser to ensure that the information and data transmitted from EPTS to the technical area during matches played in an official competition are reliable and accurate.

The FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS supports competition organisers with the approval process of reliable and accurate electronic performance and tracking systems.

Extract from Law 4 of the IFAB Laws of the Game (2025/26 edition) relating to the use of Electronic Performance and Tracking Systems (EPTS) in official competitions.
Source: IFAB Laws of the Game 2025/26 (https://downloads.theifab.com/downloads/laws-of-the-game-2025-26-single-pages?l=en)

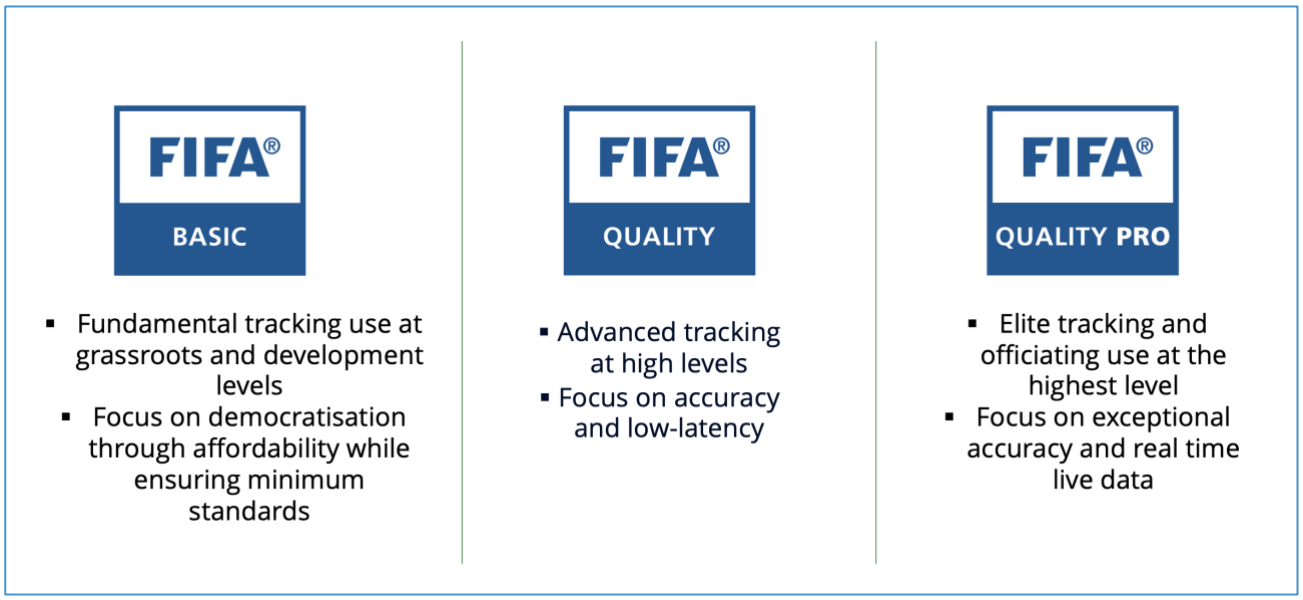
In 2019, an additional Performance standard (FIFA Quality) was launched to validate the reliability and accuracy of any EPTS system (either optical or wearable) to provide guidance to competition organisers when appointing a provider of tracking systems for their competition. This introduction was made to provide the end user with more information about the system they are using or intending to use. Providers that have been tested are listed on our website with a publicly available test report which describes, using a ranking system, the accuracy of the system's positioning and velocity data in different velocity brackets. As of 2023, wearable systems (most notably worn on the lower limbs) that have successfully gone through additional validation of the FIFA Innovation Programme can also be approved under the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS.

In January 2026, FIFA introduced a revised certification structure for the FIFA Quality Programme for Electronic Performance & Tracking Systems (EPTS), with the objective of broadening the scope of the programme and providing clearer performance benchmarks across different technology categories and use cases.

Under this updated structure:

- FIFA Basic certification was extended from a safety-only certification for wearable systems to a combined safety and performance certification pathway.
- FIFA Basic certification was also opened to optical tracking systems through the introduction of a dedicated FIFA Basic performance testing route.
- A new FIFA Basic Performance Test protocol was implemented, using a different testing methodology than the FIFA Quality protocol. The details of this protocol are described in the latest FIFA EPTS Test Manual.
- The FIFA Quality Pro certification was introduced for advanced performance validation of EPTS systems.
- Pass/fail performance thresholds were implemented for all FIFA certification marks (FIFA Basic, FIFA Quality and FIFA Quality Pro), defining the minimum technical requirements that systems must achieve in order to obtain certification.

This updated certification framework aims to provide clearer benchmarking, improve transparency for end users, and better reflect the different levels of tracking technologies currently used across football environments.



All tests are performed by accredited, independent Test Institutes and certified systems are listed on the Football Innovation website www.fifa.com/technical/football-technology/resource-hub for end-user guidance.

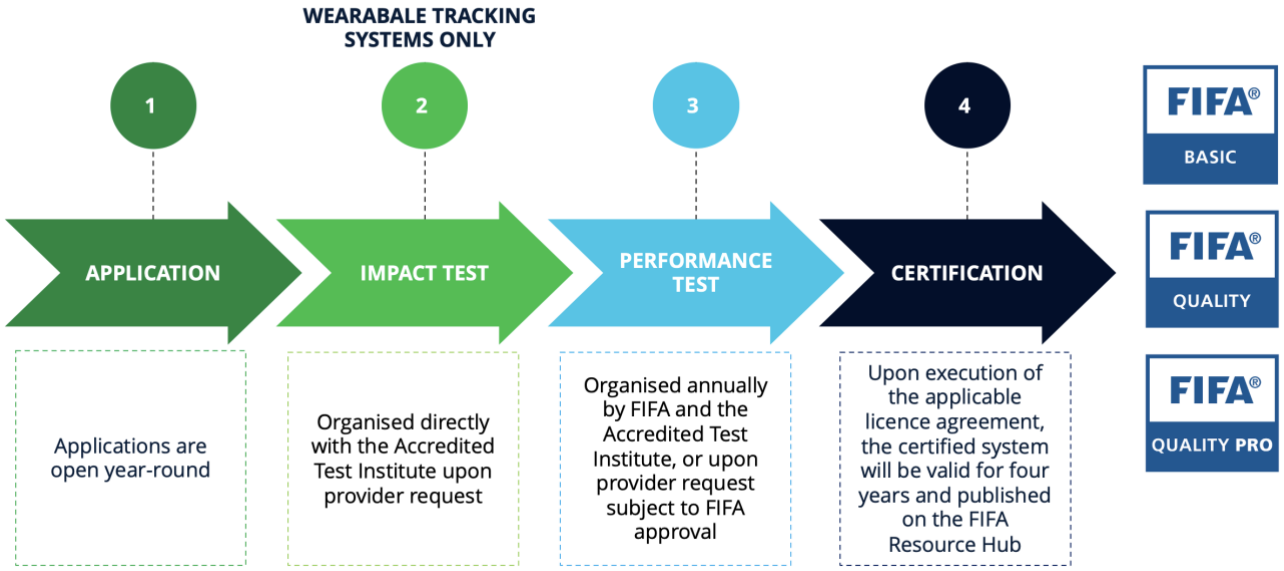
The following document is a guide for any company seeking to test and certify their tracking devices to the requirements of the FIFA Quality Programme.

Certification process for Electronic Performance & Tracking Systems for FIFA Basic, FIFA Quality and FIFA Quality Pro

Any provider of Electronic Performance and Tracking Systems (EPTS) who wishes to test and certify their EPTS technology, whether wearable or optical, may apply for FIFA Basic and/or FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification.

The applicable certification route depends on the certification mark sought by the provider. FIFA Basic and FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro are based on different test requirements, test conditions and reference systems, as defined in the applicable FIFA EPTS Test Manual.

Providers shall follow the step-by-step process below as guidance for the application and certification process.



Step	Optical Systems	Wearable Systems
Step 1 | Application & Requesting the test	✓	✓
Step 2a | Impact Assessment Test		✓
Step 2b | WFSGI pledge		✓
Step 3 | Product Liability Insurance (PLI)	✓	✓
Step 4 | Performance Test	✓	✓
Step 5 | Certification	✓	✓

Certification of a system requires the successful completion of the applicable test requirements and the execution of the relevant licence agreement:

- Non-commercial Licence Agreement for systems certified to the FIFA Basic standard
- Standard Licence Agreement for systems certified to the FIFA Quality or FIFA Quality Pro standard

Step 1 | Application & Requesting the test

The EPTS provider submits the company and product details that it wishes to test to FIFA through quality@fifa.org. The application form to be completed is available in Appendix 2.

COMPANY DETAILS	
Legal registered company name	
Legal registered company address	
Company registration number	
Main contact name	
Main contact email address	
Main contact phone number	
Authorised signatory/signatories (name, email address and title)	
Manufacturer name, contact name and contact email address (wearable providers only)	
Company website	
PRODUCT DETAILS	
Product name	
Type of product	☐ GNSS wearable ☐ LPS wearable ☐ Optical tracking system ☐ Other
Type of optical tracking system (if applicable)	☐ Single-location system (centre-of-mass tracking) ☐ Multi-location system (skeletal tracking)
Wearable device location(s) (if applicable)	☐ Upper-body location ☐ Lower-limb location
Type of test	☐ Safety Test (wearable providers only) ☐ Performance Test ☐ Safety and Performance Test (wearable providers only)
Is this a re-test?	☐ Yes (a system tested previously) ☐ No (a system not tested previously)
Target outcome	☐ FIFA Basic certification ☐ FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification ☐ Research and Development test (performance test only)

Once the application documents have been submitted, FIFA will initiate a company compliance check. Should no issues arise during this check, then the application can proceed. The company details used during the compliance check will be used for any future Licence Agreements.

Upon approval of the application, FIFA will inform the provider of the applicable next steps. For wearable systems, FIFA may instruct the selected Test Institute to start the Impact Assessment Test. For performance testing, FIFA will provide further information on the relevant test event and applicable testing route.

Step 2a | Impact Assessment Test (Wearable devices only)

The Impact Assessment Test is mandatory under the Laws of the Game for all wearable EPTS devices used in official competitions, whether worn on the upper body or on the lower limbs.

To request an Impact Assessment Test, the provider must first contact FIFA and submit the required information through the application form. Once the application has been reviewed, FIFA will provide the provider with the relevant contact details of the Accredited Test Institute responsible for conducting the test.

The provider shall then liaise directly with the Accredited Test Institute and comply with the applicable Impact Assessment Test requirements, including providing the required number of wearable units for testing. Further information on the Impact Assessment Test protocol is available in the FIFA EPTS Impact Assessment Test Manual, which can be found here: https://inside.fifa.com/innovation/documents.

Accredited Test Institute
Sports Labs Ltd 1 Adam Square Brucefield Industry Park Livingston West Lothian EH54 9DE Scotland E-Mail: info@sportslabs.co.uk

Upon completion of the test, the Test Institute will send the final test report to FIFA once the test fee has been paid to the Test Institute. For an overview of the applicable fees and payment responsibilities, please refer to Appendix 1 – Payment Scenarios.

Step 2b | WFSGI pledge (Wearable devices only)

FIFA asks all manufacturers of Wearable EPTS devices to provide a pledge (valid for a period of two years) from the World Federation of the Sporting Goods Industry (WFSGI) which certifies that production meets the industry standards. For details, please contact the WFSGI directly at pledge@wfsgi.org or +41 31 939 60 61 referring to the FIFA Quality Programme wearable EPTS devices. For this process FIFA recommends allowing 2–3 months.

Step 3 | Product Liability Insurance (PLI)

Proof of Product Liability Insurance that is valid for the whole certification is an essential part of the Licence Agreement. This is compulsory for all EPTS providers (Wearable and Optical). This insurance is primarily in the interest of the licensee to ensure protection in case of any claim in connection with the use of the technology. In order to be eligible to enter into a licence agreement with FIFA the following criteria must be met:

Product Liability Insurance – minimum requirements	
1	Name and address of licensee (policyholder)
2	Territorial scope of application: worldwide coverage needed (incl. USA & Canada), no exclusions allowed
3	Period – Coverage needed throughout whole contract period
4	FIFA must be named as a co-insured or additionally insured party
5	Coverage: A minimum of CHF 5 million per claim for bodily injuries, property damages and pure financial losses

If the national insurance market does not provide adequate insurance solutions, it is helpful and constructive to use an insurance broker with access to the international insurance market. The applicant has to provide written confirmation from the insurance company that the product liability insurance will be concluded as per the terms and conditions of the Licence Agreement. It is the responsibility of the technology provider to ensure that their product liability insurance is valid throughout the contractual period and to provide FIFA with evidence of any renewals.

Step 4 | Performance Test

An annual Performance Test event will be organised by FIFA and the Accredited Test Institute. FIFA will communicate the test dates to all licensees and registered applicants a minimum of six weeks in advance of the event. Providers may submit multiple systems for testing and certification during the same Performance Test event, subject to FIFA approval and the applicable testing capacity.

For FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification, providers are required to attend the test event on site with the tracking system(s) they wish to validate. Testing will be conducted under stadium conditions.

For FIFA Basic certification, providers are recommended to attend the test event on site. However, subject to FIFA's approval, the test may be conducted remotely under the supervision of the Accredited Test Institute. Testing will be conducted under training-ground conditions.

All Performance Tests will be conducted in accordance with the applicable test protocol defined in the latest FIFA EPTS Test Manual, available here: https://inside.fifa.com/innovation/documents.

The applicable test fees for FIFA Basic and FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification will be communicated to providers together with the Performance Test event information. For an overview of the applicable fees and payment responsibilities, please refer to Appendix 1 – Payment Scenarios.

Accredited Test Institute
Institute for Sports Tech Standards (ISTS) Post Office Box 80 Mount Martha Victoria 3934 Australia Email: sam@sportstechstandards.com

EPTS providers guarantee their attendance at the Performance test by signing a Terms & Conditions document, supplied by FIFA prior to testing.

The Performance Test serves two routes for providers:

a) FIFA Basic / FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification

The certification aims to certify a system for 4 years and publishes it on the FIFA website. For this the provider must be a licensee of the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS. Further information can be found in Step 5.

b) Product Research & Development

These results are not published on the FIFA website but allow providers to gain insight into the accuracy and validity of their system(s). This testing route is open to any provider and does not require the provider to already be a licensee of the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS. A non-branded FIFA report will be provided at the end of the analysis.

If, upon receipt of the test results, a provider wishes to use the results obtained through the R&D route for certification purposes, the provider shall then follow the applicable certification pathway for FIFA Basic, FIFA Quality or FIFA Quality Pro, in accordance with this Application Guide. Certification will only be granted once all applicable requirements have been fulfilled, including the completion of the relevant licence agreement and any associated administrative steps.

Step 5 | FIFA Certification

Following successful completion of the applicable certification requirements, the provider may enter into the relevant licence agreement with FIFA. Certified systems from licensees with valid licence agreements will be listed on the FIFA Resource Hub as FIFA Basic, FIFA Quality or FIFA Quality Pro EPTS systems, in accordance with Law 4 of the Laws of the Game.

a) FIFA Basic

FIFA Basic certification represents the entry-level certification under the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS and fulfils the minimum requirements of the Laws of the Game for the use of EPTS systems in official competitions. Subject to successful completion of the applicable Performance Test requirements and, for wearable systems, the applicable safety requirements, FIFA will issue a Non-commercial Licence Agreement.

The Non-commercial Licence Agreement is valid for four years, does not include any annual contract fee, and may cover any system tested or re-tested for FIFA Basic certification during that period.

b) FIFA Basic (Interim)

On an exceptional basis, and subject to FIFA's prior review and approval, a provider may request an interim FIFA Basic certification for a maximum period of three months.

This interim certification may only be considered where the provider has successfully completed the relevant Impact Assessment Test or holds a valid impact test result for the system concerned. It is intended to support compliance with Law 4 of the Laws of the Game where a system is required for use in an official tournament and the provider's certification has expired or is pending renewal.

Interim FIFA Basic certification is not granted automatically and remains subject to the provider completing the applicable FIFA Basic certification process in accordance with this Application Guide.

c) FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro

FIFA Quality and FIFA Quality Pro certification represent the advanced performance certification levels under the FIFA Quality Programme for EPTS.

Subject to successful completion of the applicable Performance Test requirements and, for wearable systems, the applicable safety requirements, FIFA will issue a Standard Licence Agreement.

The Standard Licence Agreement is valid for four years and includes the applicable contract fee. FIFA will only countersign the agreement once the provider has approved the publication of at least one certified system result on the FIFA website

Appendixes

Appendix 1 – Payment Scenarios

		FIFA			Sports Labs	ISTS	WFSGI	PLI
		Contract Fee	Non-commercial Licence Agreement	Standard Licence Agreement	Safety Test Fee	Performance Test Fee	Pledge Fee	Product Liability Insurance
FIFA QUALITY / FIFA QUALITY PRO	Wearable	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Optical	✓		✓		✓		✓
FIFA BASIC	Wearable		✓		✓	✓	✓	✓
	Optical		✓			✓		✓

Appendix 2 – Company Details and Product Details

COMPANY DETAILS	
Legal registered company name	
Legal registered company address	
Company registration number	
Main contact name	
Main contact email address	
Main contact phone number	
Authorised signatory/signatories (name, email address and title)	
Manufacturer name, contact name and contact email address (wearable providers only)	
Company website	
PRODUCT DETAILS	
Product name	
Type of product	☐ GNSS wearable ☐ LPS wearable ☐ Optical tracking system ☐ Other
Type of optical tracking system (if applicable)	☐ Single-location system (centre-of-mass tracking) ☐ Multi-location system (skeletal tracking)
Wearable device location(s) (if applicable)	☐ Upper-body location ☐ Lower-limb location
Type of test	☐ Safety Test (wearable providers only) ☐ Performance Test ☐ Safety and Performance Test (wearable providers only)
Is this a re-test?	☐ Yes (a system tested previously) ☐ No (a system not tested previously)
Target outcome	☐ FIFA Basic certification ☐ FIFA Quality / FIFA Quality Pro certification ☐ Research and Development test (performance test only)